STUDY AID · MATTHEW 11:1-19 · EPISODE 19 OF 58

More Than a *Prophet*

Blessed is he who does not take offense at Me.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 11:1-19 in the LSB | 28:05 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 11:1-19 – Jesus vs. John the Baptist Disagreement EXPLAINED. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 11:1-19. John, in prison, sends his disciples to ask Jesus, 'Are You the One who is to come, or shall we look for someone else?' Jesus points to His works and adds a beatitude: 'blessed is he who does not take offense at Me.' Then He praises John to the crowds as more than a prophet, the messenger of Malachi 3:1 and the Elijah who was to come, and compares 'this generation' to children in the marketplace.
- The video's bold claim: John got Jesus wrong. John had preached that judgment was near: the axe at the root, the winnowing fork in hand (3:10-12). Jesus did none of that; He taught a kingdom that grows slowly, like a mustard seed and leaven (13:31-33). If John held the Essenes' view of an imminent, fiery end, the delay would puzzle him. Jesus taught that the old age and the new overlap for a time (12:32; Mark 10:30; Luke 18:30).
- Jesus answers with evidence, stringing together Isaiah 26:19, 29:18-19, 35:5-6 and 61:1. Each of those passages also speaks of judgment, but Jesus stops short of it. He does not mention release for captives, which John in prison might have hoped for. Then: 'blessed is he who does not take offense at Me' (11:6), trust Me even when what I do does not make sense yet.
- Jesus defends John before the crowds. Verses 10-14 form a chiasm: John is the messenger (11:10) and John is Elijah (11:14) are the bookends; at the center, 11:12: 'the kingdom of heaven suffers violence, and violent men take

> *"The bottom line is John expects Jesus to be doing stuff that he's not doing.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Blessed is the one who trusts me even when I do something that doesn't initially make sense.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

it by force.' With D. A. Carson, the teacher reads it as the kingdom forcefully advancing while violent men try to plunder it. That explains why John is in prison: where the kingdom advances, some will attack it.

- The parable (11:16-19): children in the marketplace call out to their playmates, angry that they won't join the wedding game (flute and dancing) or the funeral game (dirge and mourning). The playmates who won't play are John and Jesus: John fasts and they say 'He has a demon'; Jesus eats with tax collectors and sinners and they call Him a glutton and a drunkard. 'Yet wisdom is vindicated by her deeds.'
- The lesson: in order to understand what the Lord is doing, the people have to trust Him first. They trusted their expectations; even John did. Blessed is the one who recognizes that the Lord is not doing what they think He should, and trusts Him anyway.



John the Baptist preaching

James Tissot, Saint John the Baptist and the Pharisees, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



John in prison

Guercino, Saint John the Baptist Visited in Prison by Salome, 1624-1626 (historic photograph). Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Put the pieces on the table

The teacher's method: collect the odd details first (an unexpected beatitude, a chiasm with a puzzling center, a parable), lay them out like pieces on a table, then ask what lesson they add up to for the original audience. For a parable, ask who each character stands for and where you fit in the story.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 11:1-19, looks back to John's preaching in chapter 3, and traces Jesus' words to Isaiah, Malachi and Exodus. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 11:1-19
Read in full: John's question, Jesus' answer, and the children in the marketplace.

Luke 7:18-35
Luke's account of the same scene.

Matthew 3:10-12
John's warning: the axe, the winnowing fork, the fire.

Matthew 13:31-33
The mustard seed and the leaven: a kingdom that grows slowly.

Isaiah 26:19
'Your dead will live.'

Isaiah 29:18-19
The deaf will hear and the blind will see.

Isaiah 35:4-6
Blind, deaf, lame and mute healed, and God 'will come with vengeance.'

Isaiah 61:1-2
Good news to the afflicted, release to captives, and the day of vengeance.

Malachi 3:1
'I am going to send My messenger.'

Exodus 23:20
'I am going to send an angel before you.'

Malachi 4:5
Elijah before the day of Yahweh.

Matthew 11:20-30
Coming next: woes on the cities, and 'Come to Me.'

Key verses in the LSB

> “And blessed is he who does not take offense at Me.”
>
> Matthew 11:6 (LSB)

> “And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffers violence, and violent men take it by force.”
>
> Matthew 11:12 (LSB)

> “Yet wisdom is vindicated by her deeds.”
>
> Matthew 11:19 (LSB)

Are You the One?

What John expected, what Jesus did, and a beatitude for doubters.

JOHN IN PRISON · MATTHEW 11:2-3

Are You the One?

MATTHEW 11:2-3 (LSB)

QUESTION

“Now when John in prison heard of the works of Christ, he sent word by his disciples and said to Him, “Are You the One who is to come, or shall we look for someone else?””

FROM THE VIDEO John's disciples had confronted Jesus once before, about fasting (9:14). Now John himself asks. What follows is an in-house disagreement between the Messiah and His baptizer. Matthew 9:14

BACKGROUND Matthew tells later why Herod Antipas had jailed John: John had said his marriage to Herodias was unlawful (14:3-4). Matthew 14:3-4

◆ Factbook: John the Baptist ◆ Factbook: Herod Antipas

WHAT JOHN EXPECTED · MATTHEW 3:10-12

The axe at the root

JOHN · MATTHEW 3:12

“His winnowing fork is in His hand, and He will thoroughly clear His threshing floor; and He will gather His wheat into the barn, but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.””

JESUS · MATTHEW 13:33

“He spoke another parable to them, “The kingdom of heaven is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three sata of flour until it was all leavened.””

FROM THE VIDEO The video: John got it wrong about Jesus. He preached that judgment was so near the axe was already at the root (3:10). Jesus came and did none of that; He taught a kingdom like a mustard seed, wheat and weeds together, and leaven: a slow process. Matthew 3:10 Matthew 13:24-33

FROM THE VIDEO Some think John was an Essene. If so, he expected an imminent judgment with power and glory through the Messiah: the old age going out with a bang. But the old and new ages overlap for a time ('this age' and 'the age to come': 12:32; Mark 10:30; Luke 18:30). Matthew 12:32 Mark 10:30

◆ Factbook: Essenes ◆ Factbook: Judgment ◆ Factbook: Threshing floor

JESUS' ANSWER · MATTHEW 11:4-5

Go and report what you hear and see

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 35:5-6

“Then the eyes of the blind will be opened, / And the ears of the deaf will be unstopped. Then the lame will leap like a deer, / And the tongue of the mute will shout for joy.”

MATTHEW 11:4-5 (LSB)

EVIDENCE

“And Jesus answered and said to them, “Go and report to John what you hear and see: the blind receive sight and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.”

FROM THE VIDEO Instead of chiding John, Jesus points to objective evidence, stringing together Isaiah 26:19, 29:18-19, 35:5-6 and 61:1.

Isaiah 26:19 | Isaiah 29:18-19 | Isaiah 61:1

FROM THE VIDEO Each of those Isaiah passages also promises judgment in its immediate context ('your God will come with vengeance,' 35:4), but Jesus stops short of quoting it. Isaiah 35:4

BACKGROUND Isaiah 61:1 also promises 'release to captives / And freedom to prisoners.' Jesus does not mention it to John, who is in prison. Isaiah 61:1-2

◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Healing ◆ Factbook: Leprosy

🙏

A BEATITUDE · MATTHEW 11:6

Blessed is he who does not take offense

🙏 MATTHEW 11:6 (LSB)

TRUST

“And blessed is he who does not take offense at Me.””

FROM THE VIDEO This should sound familiar: it is a beatitude, the 'Blessed are...' form that opened the Sermon on the Mount (5:3-12).

Matthew 5:3

FROM THE VIDEO Its meaning: blessed is the one who trusts Me even when I do something that doesn't initially make sense. Maybe Jesus is freeing captives, just not in the way that is immediately obvious.

BACKGROUND 'Take offense' is skandalizō, 'to stumble' or 'fall away' (compare 13:57; 26:31).

◆ Factbook: The Beatitudes

> *“The bottom line is John expects Jesus to be doing stuff that he's not doing.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

More than a prophet

The video reads 11:10-14 as a chiasm: John the messenger and John as Elijah frame the center.

MATTHEW 11:10-14 (LSB): THE FRAME IS HIGHLIGHTED; THE VIDEO'S CENTER IS GOLD

A 11:10 This is the one about whom it is written, / ‘Behold, I send My messenger ahead of You, / Who will prepare Your way before You.’

B **11:11** Truly I say to you, among those born of women there has not arisen anyone greater than John the Baptist! Yet the one who is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

C **11:12** And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffers violence, and violent men take it by force.

B' **11:13** For all the prophets and the Law prophesied until John.

A' **11:14** And if you are willing to accept it, John himself is Elijah who was to come.

The video's chiasm: A and A' name John's role from Malachi; B and B' place John at the turn of the ages; C is the center.



MATTHEW 11:7-9

A reed shaken by the wind?

MATTHEW 11:7-9 (LSB)

NOT WEAK

“Now as these men were going away, Jesus began to speak to the crowds about John, “What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind? But what did you go out to see? A man dressed in soft clothing? Behold, those who wear soft clothing are in kings’ palaces! But what did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and one who is more than a prophet.”

FROM THE VIDEO The crowds knew John: he was famous. Watching the two disagree in public, they might start to doubt both. So Jesus defends John: his question did not come from weakness, moral failure, or fear of prison.

BACKGROUND Reeds grew along the Jordan where John baptized. Kings' palaces like Herod Antipas's at Tiberias held men in soft clothing; John, in camel's hair, was nothing like the king who jailed him (3:4).

◆ Factbook: Wilderness ◆ Factbook: Jordan River ◆ Factbook: Herod Antipas



MALACHI 3:1 · MATTHEW 11:10

Behold, I send My messenger

MALACHI · MALACHI 3:1

““Behold, I am going to send My messenger, and he will prepare the way before Me. And the Lord, whom you seek, will suddenly come to His temple; and the messenger of the covenant, in whom you delight, behold, He is coming,” says Yahweh of hosts.”

MOSES · EXODUS 23:20

““Behold, I am going to send an angel before you to keep you along the way and to bring you into the place which I have prepared.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus quotes Malachi 3:1 and probably alludes to Exodus 23:20 to link John to Elijah, whom Malachi promises 'before the coming of the great and awesome day of Yahweh' (Malachi 4:5). Malachi 4:5

BACKGROUND In Malachi it is 'before Me' (God); in Matthew 'ahead of You': the Lord who comes is Jesus.

◆ Factbook: Malachi ◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Moses

THE CENTER · MATTHEW 11:12

The kingdom suffers violence

MATTHEW 11:12 (LSB)

CENTER

“And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffers violence, and violent men take it by force.”

FROM THE VIDEO This verse has sent translators in different directions. The teacher sides with D. A. Carson: the kingdom is not passively suffering violence but forcefully advancing, while violent or rapacious men try to plunder it.

FROM THE VIDEO Because it sits at the center of the chiasm, it is what Jesus wants hearers to focus on. Imprisonment is not unexpected; it is part of the kingdom advancing. Jesus is explaining why John is in jail, and showing that none of this undermines God's plan, John, or Himself.

BACKGROUND Luke's version: 'the good news of the kingdom of God is proclaimed, and everyone is forcing his way into it' (Luke 16:16). Luke 16:16

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

MATTHEW 11:13-15

John himself is Elijah

MATTHEW 11:13-15 (LSB)

ELIJAH

“For all the prophets and the Law prophesied until John. And if you are willing to accept it, John himself is Elijah who was to come. He who has ears to hear, let him hear.”

FROM THE VIDEO Why does Jesus care whether the people, and by extension John, are willing to accept it? Why talk about ears? Maybe the answer is tied to the lesson for them.

BACKGROUND John even dressed like Elijah: a leather belt around his waist (3:4; 2 Kings 1:8). Later Jesus says again, 'Elijah already came, and they did not recognize him' (17:12). 2 Kings 1:8 Matthew 17:10-13

◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Law of Moses ◆ Factbook: The Prophets (books)

> *“Blessed is the one who trusts me even when I do something that doesn't initially make sense.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Children in the marketplace

Who the children are, who will not play, and how a parable reads you.

THE PARABLE · MATTHEW 11:16-17

Children in the marketplace

🎶 MATTHEW 11:16-17 (LSB)

PARABLE

““But to what shall I compare this generation? It is like children sitting in the marketplaces, who call out to the other children, and say, ‘We played the flute for you, and you did not dance; we sang a dirge, and you did not mourn.’”

FROM THE VIDEO Ancient Jewish parables often began, 'A parable: to what may it be compared? It is like...' The force of a parable is felt through the comparison. Listeners step inside the story, find where they fit, and face a crisis of decision.

FROM THE VIDEO The children are 'this generation.' They call out critically to their playmates, upset that they will not join their games: a wedding game (flute and dancing) and a funeral game (dirge and mourning).



MATTHEW 11:18-19

A glutton and a drunkard?

🍞 MATTHEW 11:18-19 (LSB)

PLAYMATES

“For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, ‘He has a demon!’ The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Behold, a gluttonous man and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!’ Yet wisdom is vindicated by her deeds.””

FROM THE VIDEO Who are the playmates who won't play? John and Jesus. That is why Jesus goes straight to the criticisms of each: John's fasting is called demonic, and Jesus' table fellowship with sinners is called gluttony.

FROM THE VIDEO What John and Jesus are doing is the wisdom of God at work, and her deeds prove it right (11:19).

BACKGROUND 'A glutton and a drunkard' echoes the charge against a rebellious son in Deuteronomy 21:20. Deuteronomy 21:20

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Tax collector ◆ Factbook: Sinner ◆ Factbook: Fasting



WHO IS INTERPRETED?

The parable reads the listener

FROM THE VIDEO A parable is not only interpreted by the listener; the listener is interpreted by the parable. The crowd had to see themselves among the sulking children.

FROM THE VIDEO The teacher cites the scholar Joachim Jeremias (the captions say 'Wim Jeremas') for the sense: you give orders and criticize; you call the Baptist mad because he fasts, and Jesus for eating with tax collectors. You reject both the call to repent and the good news, and play childish games with God's messengers.

BACKGROUND Luke ends the parable, 'wisdom is vindicated by all her children' (Luke 7:35): those who received John and Jesus. Luke 7:29-35

◆ Factbook: Repentance ◆ Factbook: Gospel



Children at play

Pieter Bruegel the Elder, Children's Games, 1560. Kunsthistorisches Museum, Vienna, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"The parable is not only meant to be interpreted by the listener. What's really going on is the listener is also interpreted by the parable.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 11:1-19

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO Answers John with evidence, adds a beatitude, defends John, and tells the parable of the children.

BACKGROUND Luke adds that 'at that very time' He healed many (Luke 7:21).

Luke 7:21-23 ◆ Jesus Christ

John the Baptist

VIDEO In prison, asks if Jesus is the One. The video: his expectations were wrong.

BACKGROUND Josephus says Herod Antipas held and executed John at the fortress of Machaerus (Antiquities 18.5.2).

Matthew 14:3-12 ◆ John the Baptist ◆ Machaerus ◆ Flavius Josephus ◆ Herod Antipas ◆ Herodias

John's disciples

VIDEO Carry John's question to Jesus.

BACKGROUND They had asked Jesus about fasting before (9:14), and later bury John (14:12).

Matthew 9:14 Matthew 14:12 ◆ Disciples

The crowds

VIDEO Watch a public disagreement; Jesus speaks to them about John.

BACKGROUND Many had gone out to the Jordan to be baptized by John (3:5-6).

Matthew 3:5-6

◆ Fasting

Elijah

VIDEO John is 'Elijah who was to come' (11:14).

BACKGROUND Elijah was taken up in a whirlwind (2 Kings 2:11); Malachi 4:5 promised his return.

Malachi 4:5 | 2 Kings 2:11 | ◆ Elijah (prophet) | ◆ Malachi

This generation

VIDEO The sulking children who reject both John and Jesus.

BACKGROUND Jesus uses 'this generation' for the unbelieving people of His day (12:39-45; 23:36).

Matthew 12:39

Tax collectors and sinners

VIDEO Jesus' table companions, the reason for the 'friend of' insult.

BACKGROUND Compare 9:10-13, at Matthew's house.

Matthew 9:10-13 | ◆ Tax collector | ◆ Sinner

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

From the prison to Galilee

Gold pins are background; the pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to.



● Named in the video ● Background ▬ John's disciples carry his question to Jesus (11:2): route is schematic

Positions of cities from their known sites; regions and the route are approximate and schematic. Machaerus, east of the Dead Sea, lies just south of this map; Josephus places John's imprisonment there. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' base, near where He taught and preached 'in their cities' (11:1).

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Tiberias BACKGROUND

Herod Antipas's capital, one of the 'kings' palaces' of 11:8.

◆ Factbook: Tiberias ◆ Factbook: Herod Antipas

Jordan River VIDEO

The wilderness by the Jordan where crowds went out to see John (3:5-6; 11:7).

◆ Factbook: Jordan River ◆ Factbook: Wilderness

Jerusalem BACKGROUND

Many of John's hearers came from Jerusalem and Judea (3:5).

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

08

Key terms

Eschatology

VIDEO

Teaching about the last things: judgment, the age to come. The captions spell it 'esquetology.'

◆ Factbook: Judgment ◆ Factbook: Eschatology

This age and the age to come

VIDEO

Jewish way of dividing history; Jesus speaks of both (12:32; Mark 10:30). The video: in Jesus the two overlap for a time.

Essenes

VIDEO

A strict Jewish group expecting God's imminent judgment; some lived in the wilderness. Whether John was one is debated.

◆ Factbook: Essenes ◆ Factbook: Qumran

Beatitude

VIDEO

A 'blessed is' saying, like 5:3-12 and 11:6.

◆ Factbook: The Beatitudes

Chiasm

VIDEO

A mirrored pattern (A B C B' A') whose main point sits at the center. The captions spell it 'kayazm.'

◆ Factbook: Chiasm

Pericope

VIDEO

A unit of text, such as one story or teaching. The captions say 'paricopy.'

Parable

VIDEO

A short story or comparison in which the characters illustrate a lesson, often about how God deals with people.

Wisdom

BACKGROUND

God's wisdom personified, as in Proverbs 8-9; 'vindicated by her deeds' (11:19).

◆ Factbook: Parable

◆ Factbook: Book of Proverbs

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

δεσμωτήριον

desmōtērion G1201

Prison.

Greek · Matt 11:2

◆ Factbook: John the Baptist

ἔρχομαι

erchomai G2064

To come; 'the One who is to come.'

Greek · Matt 11:3

σκανδαλίζω

skandalizō G4624

To cause to stumble; passive: take offense, fall away. Look up: BDAG, σκανδαλίζω.

Greek · Matt 11:6

κάλαμος

kalamos G2563

Reed.

Greek · Matt 11:7

μαλακός

malakos G3120

Soft (of fine clothing).

Greek · Matt 11:8

ἄγγελος

angelos G32

Messenger, angel.

Greek · Matt 11:10

◆ Factbook: Angel

βιάζω

biazō G971

Middle: to press forward forcefully; passive: to suffer violence. Look up: BDAG, βιάζω.

Greek · Matt 11:12

βιαστής

biastēs G973

A violent, forceful person.

Greek · Matt 11:12

ἁρπάζω

harpazō G726

To seize, snatch, take by force.

Greek · Matt 11:12

προσφωνέω

prosphōneō G4377

To call out to, address.

Greek · Matt 11:16

θρηνέω

thrēneō G2354

To sing a dirge, lament.

Greek · Matt 11:17

◆ Factbook: Mourning

κόπτω

koptō G2875

To beat the breast in mourning.

Greek · Matt 11:17

◆ Factbook: Mourning

δικαιόω

dikaioō G1344

To justify, vindicate, show to be right.

Greek · Matt 11:19

σοφία

sophia G4678

Wisdom.

Greek · Matt 11:19

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Machaerus

Herod the Great's hilltop fortress east of the Dead Sea, in Antipas's territory of Perea. Josephus says John was sent there in bonds and put to death (Antiquities 18.5.2).

Children's games

Children in ancient towns played at grown-up events: weddings with pipes and dancing, funerals with wailing and beating the breast. Refusing to play either one was a familiar childish quarrel.

Essenes

Josephus, Philo and Pliny describe the Essenes; many link them to the Qumran community near the Dead Sea. John's wilderness life and message of judgment have led some to suggest a connection, but the Gospels never call him an Essene.

Elijah expected

Malachi 4:5 promised Elijah before the day of Yahweh. Jews still pour a cup for Elijah at the Passover meal. Jesus says John fulfilled that role 'if you are willing to accept it.'

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *Whence it is evident, that neither did he send as being himself in doubt, nor did he ask in ignorance.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 36, on 11:3. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *For both of them received one ministry, and both of them became forerunners.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 37, on 11:14 (John and Elijah). NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"Is fasting a good thing, and to be admired? You should then have obeyed John, and received him, and believed his sayings.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 37, on 11:18-19. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Did John doubt?

The video: yes; John's expectations of judgment were wrong. Chrysostom: no; John asked for his disciples' sake, 'neither did he send as being himself in doubt.' Others: a real but faithful question from a prisoner. Jesus answers kindly and then praises John.

Violence against the kingdom, or the kingdom advancing?

The Greek verb in 11:12 can be read as passive ('suffers violence') or middle ('forcefully advances'). Some read 'violent men' as opponents like Herod; others as eager people pressing in (compare Luke 16:16). Chrysostom took it as stirring hearers to earnestness.

Was John an Essene?

Possible but unproven. John lived in the wilderness and preached imminent judgment, like the Qumran community, but he called all Israel to repent and baptized once, unlike the Essenes' repeated washings.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Isaiah 61:1 holds both phrases: 'To bring good news to the afflicted' and 'To proclaim release to captives.' The video says Jesus quotes 'the verse right before'; it is the same verse.
- The Greek of 11:12 can be read as middle ('forcefully advances') or passive ('suffers violence'). The reading the video takes from D. A. Carson is the middle, not the 'active voice.'
- The word for the children 'calling out' (prosphōneō) simply means to call out to someone; the critical tone comes from the context, not the word itself.
- The summary of the parable is credited to Joachim Jeremias (captions: 'Wim Jeremas'); the wording could not be checked here. Lepers being cleansed is not in the Isaiah passages Jesus draws on; that sign stands on its own (compare 2 Kings 5).
- That John was an Essene is a guess, not a fact; the Gospels never say so.

From Exodus to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 11:1-19 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

c. 1446 BC DEBATED
'I am going to send an angel before you'
Exodus 23:20 *Echo: 11:10*

c. 850 BC DEBATED
Elijah, a hairy man with a leather girdle
2 Kings 1:8

c. 700 BC DEBATED
Isaiah: the blind see, the deaf hear
Isaiah 35:5-6 *Echo: 11:5*

c. 430 BC DEBATED
Malachi: My messenger, and Elijah before the day
Malachi 3:1 *Echo: 11:10, 14*

c. AD 28 DEBATED
John jailed by Herod Antipas
Matthew 14:3-4

c. AD 29 DEBATED
John's question and Jesus' answer
Matthew 11:1-19 *This episode*

c. AD 93
Josephus records John's death at Machaerus
Matthew 14:10

c. AD 390
Chrysostom: John did not send 'as being himself in doubt'
Matthew 11:3

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 7:18-35
Luke's account
ADDED

Matthew 3:1-12
John's message of coming judgment
ADDED

Matthew 13:24-33
Wheat and weeds, mustard seed, leaven
ADDED

Matthew 17:10-13
'Elijah already came'
ADDED

Luke 1:17
In the spirit and power of Elijah
ADDED

Luke 4:16-21
Jesus reads Isaiah 61 at Nazareth
ADDED

Luke 16:16
Everyone forcing his way into the kingdom
ADDED

Proverbs 8:1-11
Wisdom calls out
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. Have you ever expected God to act one way and been surprised? What did you do with that?
2. Read Isaiah 35:4-6 and 61:1-2. What did Jesus leave out when answering John, and why might that matter?
3. What does 'blessed is he who does not take offense at Me' ask of you this week?
4. How do you read 11:12: the kingdom under attack, or the kingdom advancing? What difference does it make?
5. In the parable, are you ever one of the children who want God to play your game?
6. Where might God be working right now outside the bounds of your expectations?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

Put the pieces together: an unexpected beatitude ('blessed is he who does not take offense at Me'), a chiasm whose center says the kingdom advances and is attacked, and a parable of children who sulk because John and Jesus will not play their games. The lesson for the original audience: in order to understand what the Lord is doing, the people have

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

write down one place where God is not doing what you expected (a prayer, a plan, a relationship). Next to it, write Matthew 11:6, and one 'report' of what you have seen Him do, as Jesus told John's disciples to report what they heard and saw.

to trust Him first. They did not trust Jesus; they trusted their expectations and preconceived notions about Him. Even the best of them, John the Baptist, fell into confusion. Jesus gives this beatitude for that moment: blessed is the one who recognizes that the Lord is not doing what they think He should, and trusts Him anyway. That still speaks today: God might be doing something right now that is outside the bounds of your own expectations. What are you going to do about it?

> *"In order to understand what the Lord is doing, the people have to trust him first.*
>
> From the video

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Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Moses ◆ Herod the Great ◆ Nazareth ◆ John the Baptist ◆ Jordan River ◆ Malachi ◆ Camel ◆ Isaiah ◆ Wilderness ◆ Essenes ◆ Qumran ◆ Flavius Josephus ◆ Repentance ◆ Threshing floor ◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Angel ◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Capernaum ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Fasting ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ The Beatitudes ◆ Chiasm ◆ Demon possession ◆ Disciples ◆ Gospel ◆ Healing ◆ Herod Antipas ◆ Judea ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Machaerus ◆ Perea ◆ Prayer ◆ Book of Proverbs ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Sermon on the Mount ◆ Tax collector ◆ Tiberias ◆ Leprosy ◆ Sinner ◆ Son of Man ◆ Eschatology ◆ Herodias ◆ Messiah ◆ Mourning ◆ Parable

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